

XUEJIAN (RON) WANG

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EDUCATION

Ph.D. Agricultural Economics, Purdue University	expected August 2027
Advisor: Joseph Balagtas	
M.Sc. Applied Economics, University of Idaho	August 2023
M.A. International Trade, Zhejiang University of Finance & Economics	July 2021
B.A. Economics, Yunnan University	July 2017

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Agricultural Economics; Food Marketing and Demand Analysis; Food, Nutrition, and Health Policy; Empirical Industrial Organization

JOB MARKET PAPER

- **“The Effects of GLP-1 Medications on Household Food Demand”** (with Joseph Balagtas)

Some of the first evidence on how GLP-1 medications change household food demand and its nutritional content. A GLP-1 survey inside the NielsenIQ Consumer Panel links each household's adoption to its grocery purchases; harmonized Nutrition Facts data attach calories and nutrients to every product. Matched staggered difference-in-differences estimates show that spending falls more than calories. The basket shrinks but does not get healthier — fiber, fat, protein, and sodium all fall at adoption, while sugar does not. Status: In preparation.

RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

- **Wang, X.**, Balagtas, J. “The Supply Response to Food Quality Concerns: An Application to Synthetic Dyes”
- **Wang, X.**, Balagtas, J. “GLP-1 Medications and the Derived Demand for Meat”

WORKING PAPERS

- **Wang, X.**, Katare, B., Kundu, D. “Natural Disasters and Alcohol Sales: Evidence from Hurricanes.” *SSRN Working Paper*. ssrn.com/abstract=6999318

PUBLICATIONS

- Katare, B., **Wang, X.**, Zhao, S., Yenerall, J. (2025). “Novel Approaches to Analyze Consumer Behavior and Policies to Promote Sustainable Consumption”, *Agricultural Economics*, 56: 512–525. doi.org/10.1111/agec.70027
- Du, X., **Wang, X.** and Hatzenbuehler, P. (2022). “Digital Technology in Agriculture: A Review of Issues, Applications, and Methodologies”, *China Agricultural Economic Review*, Vol. 15 No. 1, pp. 95–108. doi.org/10.1108/CAER-01-2022-0009

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- “The Effects of GLP-1 Medications on Household Food Demand” — ASSA Annual Meeting, Washington, DC (2027, scheduled); AAEA Annual Meeting, Kansas City, MO (2026)
- “The Supply Response to Food Quality Concerns: An Application to Synthetic Dyes” — AAEA Annual Meeting, Kansas City, MO (2026)
- “Natural Disasters and Alcohol Sales: Evidence from Hurricanes” — MEA Annual Meeting, Chicago, IL (2026); CES North America Annual Meeting, Ann Arbor, MI (2025); SEA Annual Meeting, Tampa, FL (2025)
- “Market, Environmental, and Policy Implications of Manure-based Fertilizer Development in Idaho: An Agent-Based Approach” — WAEA–CAES Annual Meeting, Whistler, BC, Canada (2023)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

- Guest Lecture: AGE250: Economic Geography of World Food and Resources, Spring 2026

RESEARCH FUNDING

2024	Jim and Neta Hicks Graduate Student Small Grant, Purdue University (Role: proposal author)	\$7,500
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AWARDS

2022	Edward J. and Maud R. Iddings Research Fellowship, University of Idaho	\$4,000
2022	AAEA Travel Award	

REFeree SERVICE

- Agricultural Economics

SERVICE

Purdue University	Social Chair, Treasurer, Graduate Student Mentor, Graduate Student Organization, Department of Agricultural Economics
University of Idaho	International Student Ambassador, International Programs Office

METHODS AND SKILLS

Methods	Applied microeconometrics: matched staggered difference-in-differences with heterogeneity-robust estimators; event-study designs; panel and reduced-form policy evaluation
Data	Construction of large household- and product-level panels from consumer panel and retail scanner data (NielsenIQ, Kilts Center); harmonization of nutrition data across multiple product-level sources; linking survey responses to household purchase records
Tools	Python, R, Stata, HPC, GIS, $\LaTeX$; reproducible, version-controlled data pipelines